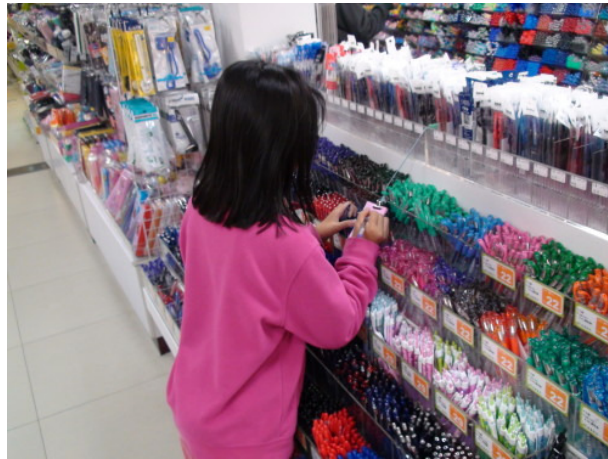




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Unit 5: Wendy's Disappearing Pens

Once, there was a little girl named Wendy. She was a very good girl because she always did her homework and helped around the house. She was her mother's little angel.

But like everyone, Wendy wasn't perfect. For some reason, she was always losing her pens and pencils. She just couldn't keep track of them no matter how hard she tried. It was as if they were disappearing into thin air.

One day, her teacher, Mrs. Martin, got angry because Wendy was always bothering other students to ask them for something to write with. Mrs. Martin had had enough. She took a pencil out of her desk, tied a piece of string around it and then loosely secured it to Wendy's wrist.

"Let's see you lose it now," Mrs. Martin proudly said as if she had solved some great problem.

Five minutes later, Wendy slowly walked up to her teacher's desk. "Um, Mrs. Martin," she said politely.

"Yes, Wendy. What is it?" Mrs. Martin asked.

"I seem to have lost my pencil again," she shyly admitted.

Her teacher was confused. She looked at Wendy's wrist and the string was still there, but as she pulled it up she could see that there was nothing on the end. Mrs. Martin was completely and utterly baffled.

"What did you do with it?" Mrs. Martin inquired. "Did you eat it or something?"

“It’s just gone,” Wendy stated.

They searched all around Wendy's desk the same way an investigator might go over a crime scene, but they found nothing. There seemed to be no trace of it. The search was then expanded to cover the entire classroom. Every nook and cranny was looked into and nothing was left unturned, but the pencil was nowhere to be found.

“Well, I don't know what to say Wendy,” Mrs. Martin confessed. “Short of putting a homing device on your pencil, there is really nothing more I can do.”

“But how can I do my work?” Wendy whined. “I need something to write with.

“Ok then. Here is 10, 000 dollars. Take it and go to the stationary store around the corner and buy every pen and pencil they have in the place. It may not keep your pencils from disappearing, but, if we have enough, it might at least get you through the rest of the semester,” Mrs. Martin explained.

“And then?” Wendy wondered.

“And then!” Mrs. Martin cackled like an old witch. “And then you are out of my hair and your next teacher can worry about it!”

Everyone in the classroom roared with laughter.